

AREA CODE 386
TEL. 786-1237

UNIVERSITY OF MANITOBA FACULTY OF MEDICINE
DEPARTMENT OF PATHOLOGY



THE CHANCELLOR, VICE
CHANCELLOR, MANITOBA
K1N 0M3.

December 3, 1972.

Robert C. Hockett, Ph.D.,
The Council for Tobacco Research,
110 East 59th Street,
New York, N.Y. 10021
U.S.A.

Dear Doctor Hockett:

Gately back in Winnipeg where we are shivering in -20° weather, I wish
to thank you for inviting me to the conference on the macrophage. Taken as a
whole I thought the conference was valuable although I must admit to some synaptic
overload during the first part of the Friday morning session.
As I left you asked for comments, so perhaps I may pinpoint the particular
areas that impressed me.

On the first day, the work of Joseph Gualtieri continues to impress me!
here is a wealth and depth of knowledge and the association of in-vivo and vitro
models has much to offer in the study of disturbed macrophagic function.
It became clear, as the discussion progressed, that there are significant gaps
in our knowledge about bactericidal mechanisms in the lung. Is it related solely
to the macrophage or are other factors such as surface area involved too?

The two papers on scanning electron microscopy were fascinating and, of
course, very beautifully presented. I think it was interesting to see the surface
changes in the adapted or pleurated. The papers of Gross and Mustafa emphasized an
important parameter, the metabolic changes that occur when the macrophage
is irritated in any way. It is important to look at the macrophage in this way
and only when this aspect is exceeded may we expect trouble.
In quantitative studies, but I don't see it as a major investigation, be of some use
since it is becoming apparent that the adaptive capacity of the macrophage is great
and only when this capacity is exceeded may we expect trouble.